Content calendar template: 3-month plan

An SEO content plan for your blog and website. Each row is one piece of content with a primary keyword, search intent, format, target URL, internal links, an owner and results from Google Search Console at 30 and 90 days (plus GA4 inquiries at 90 days).

How to use this template

1. **Set the basics** (part 1): the goal for the quarter, the audience, the service pages to support and a cadence your team can actually keep. Take topics and target pages from your SEO strategy if you have one.
2. **Build the topic backlog** (part 2) from Search Console, keyword research, Google autocomplete and People also ask, customer questions and competitor gaps. Rate each topic from 1 to 3 on three scales and work out the score.
3. **Give each topic one primary keyword** and search it on Google to see which pages rank in the top ten. That tells you the intent and the format. Keywords that share at least 4 of their top 10 results belong on one URL.
4. **Lay out the calendar** (part 3): month 1 – service pages and FAQs, month 2 – articles and comparisons, month 3 – case studies and updates.
5. **Run the checklist before publishing** (part 5), and on publish day add the 30-day and 90-day check dates.
6. **Measure and decide** (part 4): filter the Search Console Performance report by URL, add GA4 inquiries at 90 days and log your decision. Review the quarter at the end (part 6).

1. Plan basics

1 **Content goal for this quarter** (for example, more inquiries for one service)

2 **Audience** (who they are, what problem they have, where they are in the decision)

3 **Service pages your articles should lead to** (URLs)

4 **Cadence**

new pieces per month

updates per month

5 **Owner and review**

calendar owner (one person)

quarterly review date

The quarter at a glance

Month 1: foundations
Service pages and FAQs for transactional and local keywords. Without them, articles have nowhere to send traffic.

Month 2: support
Informational articles and comparisons that answer pre-purchase questions and link to your service pages.

Month 3: proof and updates
Case studies, refreshes of pages losing clicks, and the first check of month-1 content.

2. Topic backlog

Topics waiting for a slot. Score each one from 1 to 3: **V** – business value (can the topic bring in inquiries?), **C** – chance to rank, **E** – effort (3 = high). **Score = V × C ÷ E.** Topics with the highest score go into the calendar first.

#	Topic	Primary keyword	Intent	Idea source	V	C	E	Score	Month
e.g.	*How much does heat pump installation cost?*	*heat pump installation cost*	*commercial*	*customer questions*	*3*	*2*	*2*	*3*	*2*
1									
2									
3									
4									
5									
6									
7									
8									
9									
10									
11									
12									
13									
14									

Where to find topics

- [ ] **Search Console:** Performance report, Queries tab, sorted by impressions. Queries with impressions but few clicks: positions 4–20 mean expanding a page you have, lower positions with no dedicated page mean a new topic.
- [ ] **Keyword research:** how customers describe your services, what they ask and in which months they search. Keywords that share at least 4 of their top 10 results = one topic and one URL (our working rule).
- [ ] **Google autocomplete and People also ask:** your customers' exact wording. A long query usually becomes a heading or an FAQ question; it gets its own page only if the intent is different.
- [ ] **Customer questions:** from calls, emails and sales meetings. A question that keeps coming up is a topic for an FAQ or an article.
- [ ] **Competitor gaps:** topics that businesses ranking above you cover and you don't.

3. Content calendar

Intent: informational, commercial, transactional, local. Format: article, service page, FAQ, case study, comparison, update. Status: idea → brief → writing → editing → ready → published → needs update.

Month 1 · foundations · from _____ to _____

Week / date	Topic	Primary keyword	Intent	Format	Target URL	Internal links	Owner	Status	Publish date
e.g. Jan 14	*Heat pump installation in [city]*	*heat pump installation [city]*	*local*	*service page*	*/heat-pump-installation*	*from: home page*	*Anna*	*brief*	*Jan 16*
Week 1									
Week 2									
Week 3									
Week 4									
Update									

Month 2 · support · from _____ to _____

Week / date	Topic	Primary keyword	Intent	Format	Target URL	Internal links	Owner	Status	Publish date
Week 1									
Week 2									
Week 3									
Week 4									
Update									

Rule: one primary keyword, one URL. In the Internal links column, every article names the service page it points to and 2–4 related pieces on the same topic. An FAQ on a service page gets no primary keyword of its own.

Month 3 · proof and updates · from _____ to _____

Week / date	Topic	Primary keyword	Intent	Format	Target URL	Internal links	Owner	Status	Publish date
Week 1									
Week 2									
Week 3									
Week 4									
Update									

4. Results sheet (Search Console and GA4)

Search Console: Performance report → Page filter with the URL from your plan → date range starting on the publish date. Log clicks, impressions and average position at 30 and 90 days, and check on the Queries tab whether the page shows up for the primary keyword. At 90 days, add GA4 key events (for example forms or calls) from visits that started on that page.

Target URL	Publish date	Primary keyword	Clicks at 30 days	Impressions at 30 days	Clicks at 90 days	Impressions at 90 days	Avg. position at 90 days	Inquiries (GA4) at 90 days	Decision

Your decision at 90 days

No impressions
Check indexing with the URL Inspection tool and add internal links.

Impressions for the keyword, few clicks
Rewrite the title and meta description, expand the content, add links from strong pages.

Impressions for other queries
Change the keyword in the plan or rewrite the piece for the original intent.

Clicks are growing
Add a link to the service page and plan the next piece on the topic.

Clicks but no inquiries
Add a clear link to the service page and a call to action in the piece.

Two URLs for the same keyword
Merge the pages (301 redirect) or separate their intents.

5. Pre-publish checklist

- [ ] The primary keyword is in the page title, the H1 and the first paragraph. The title is about 50–60 characters: Google has no limit, but usually truncates longer titles.
- [ ] The content matches the intent you see in Google's top ten results.
- [ ] The piece adds something the top ten don't have: your own data, an example, project photos, an expert's view.
- [ ] Under each question heading, the first one or two sentences answer directly, and numbers have a source.
- [ ] The author, date and sources are visible on the page.
- [ ] No other URL on the site targets the same keyword.
- [ ] At least two existing pages link to the new piece, and it links to the right service page and 2–4 related pieces on the same topic.
- [ ] The meta description says what the reader will find and gives a reason to click.
- [ ] Any text drafted with AI has been fact-checked and edited by a person.
- [ ] The publish date is in the calendar, and the 30-day and 90-day check dates are in the team calendar.
- [ ] In GA4, form submissions and clicks on your phone number are marked as key events (GA4 does not count them retroactively).
- [ ] For updates: the "last updated" date changes only when the content has really changed.

6. Quarterly review

1. **Which pieces earned the most clicks and inquiries at 90 days, and why?**

2. **Which pieces did not deliver, and what did you decide** (expand, rewrite the title, merge, remove)**?**

3. **Did you keep the cadence? If not, what cadence will you set for next quarter?**

4. **Which pages are losing clicks year over year, and do any two URLs show up for the same keyword?**

5. **Do AI assistants and AI Overviews mention your business for the questions in your plan?**

6. **Backlog topics for next quarter's calendar** (numbers from part 2)

> Search Console keeps data for the last 16 months, so you can compare year over year without exporting. Save older data in a spreadsheet. Google counts traffic from AI Overviews and AI Mode in the same Performance report.